3. The Southern Plateaus

The southern plateaus are relatively lower than the northern plateaus. The four important southern plateaus are the **Arabian Plateau** (Saudi Arabia), **Deccan Plateau** (India), **Shan Plateau** (Myanmar) and the **Yunnan Plateau** (China). Among these plateaus, the Arabian Plateau is the largest Plateau.

4. The Great Plains

The great plains are formed by the major rivers of Asia. They are the **West Siberian plain** (Ob and Yenisey), **Manchurian Plain** (Amur), **Great Plain of China** (Yangtze and Sikiang), **Indo-Gangetic Plain** (Indus and Ganga), **Mesopotamian plain** (Tigris and Euphrates) and **the Irrawaddy plain** (Irrawaddy).

5. The Island Groups

Numerous islands are found in the Pacific coast of Southeast Asia. **Kuril, Taiwan, Singapore** and **Borneo** are the important island groups.

The **Philippines, Japan islands** and **Indonesia** are the major archipelagos in Asia. Smaller archipelagos are also located in the Indian Ocean such as the islands of **Maldives** and **Lakshadweep** in the **Arabian Sea. Bahrain** is in the **Persian Gulf. Sri Lanka** is an island, which is located in the Bay of Bengal.



A group of islands is called an archipelago. The largest archipelago is Indonesia.



Drainage

The rivers of Asia originate mostly from the central highlands. The **Ob, Yenisey** and **Lena** are the major rivers that flow towards the north and drain into the Arctic Ocean. These rivers remain frozen during winter. On the other hand, South Asia has many perennial rivers (e.g.) **Brahmaputra, Indus, Ganga** and **Irrawaddy** which originate from the snow covered high mountains that do not freeze during winter. The **Euphrates** and **Tigris** flow in West Asia. **The Amur, Huang He,**

Major Rivers of Asia

S. No	Name of the River	Origin	Outflow	Length in Km
1	Yangtze	Tibetan plateau	East China sea	6,350
2	Hung Ho	Tibetan plateau	Gulf of Pohai	5,464
3	Mekong	Tibetan plateau	South China sea	4,350
4	Yenisey	Tannuala Mountain	Arctic Ocean	4,090
5	Ob	Altai Mountain	Gulf of Ob	3,650
6	Brahmaputra	Himalayas	Bay of Bengal	2,900
7	Indus	Himalayas	Arabian sea	3,610
8	Amur	Confluence of Shika and Argun rivers	Tatar Strait	2,824
9	Ganges	Himalayas	Bay of Bengal	2,525
10	Irrawaddy	North Myanmar	Bay of Bengal	2,170

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